

COMPOSITION

Alatrol[®] Tablet: Each tablet contains 10 mg Cetirizine Hydrochloride.

DESCRIPTION, DOSAGE FORM, ROUTE OF ADMINISTRATION AND PACKAGING

A white slightly biconvex film coated tablet. Both sides are plain.

Each Box contains 100 film-coated tablets for oral use. The tablets are supplied in blister packs.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

Cetirizine, a human metabolite of hydroxyzine, is an antihistamine; its principal effects are mediated via selective inhibition of peripheral H₁ receptors. The antihistaminic activity of cetirizine has been clearly documented in a variety of animal and human models. In vivo and ex vivo animal models have shown negligible anticholinergic and antiserotonergic activity. In clinical studies, however, dry mouth was more common with cetirizine than with placebo. In vitro receptor binding studies have shown no measurable affinity for other than H₁ receptors. Autoradiographic studies with radiolabeled cetirizine in the rat have shown negligible penetration into the brain. Ex vivo experiments in the mouse have shown that systemically administered cetirizine does not significantly occupy cerebral H₁ receptors.

PHARMACOKINETICS

Absorption: Cetirizine was rapidly absorbed with a time to maximum concentration (T_{max}) of approximately 1 hour following oral administration of tablets or syrup in adults. Comparable bioavailability was found between the tablet and syrup dosage forms. When healthy volunteers were administered multiple doses of cetirizine (10 mg tablets once daily for 10 days), a mean peak plasma concentration (C_{max}) of 311 ng/mL was observed. No accumulation was observed. Cetirizine pharmacokinetics were linear for oral doses ranging from 5 to 60 mg. Food had no effect on the extent of cetirizine exposure (AUC) but T_{max} was delayed by 1.7 hours and C_{max} was decreased by 23% in the presence of food.

Distribution: The mean plasma protein binding of cetirizine is 93%, independent of concentration in the range of 25-1000 ng/mL, which includes the therapeutic plasma levels observed.

Metabolism: A mass balance study in 6 healthy male volunteers indicated that 70% of the administered radioactivity was recovered in the urine and 10% in the feces. Approximately 50% of the radioactivity was identified in the urine as unchanged drug. Most of the rapid increase in peak plasma radioactivity was associated with parent drug, suggesting a low degree of first-pass metabolism. Cetirizine is metabolized to a limited extent by oxidative O-dealkylation to a metabolite with negligible antihistaminic activity. The enzyme or enzymes responsible for this metabolism have not been identified.

Elimination: The mean elimination half-life in 146 healthy volunteers across multiple pharmacokinetic studies was 8.3 hours and the apparent total body clearance for cetirizine was approximately 53 mL/m

INDICATIONS

Adults and children of 3 years or above: symptomatic treatment of seasonal rhinitis, perennial allergic rhinitis and urticaria of allergic origin.

DOSAGE AND DIRECTIONS FOR USE

The recommended dosage in children aged between 3 and 6 years old is 5 mg daily, either 2.5 mg twice daily or 5 mg once daily.

In children 6 years old or above: 10 mg daily, either 5 mg twice daily or 10 mg once daily.

In adults, the recommended dose is 10 mg once daily.

In patients with renal insufficiency, dosage should be reduced to half the daily dose

It is advisable to take the drug with a little liquid during the evening meal since the symptoms for which the product is given usually appear during the night.

In patients affected by side effects, the dose may be taken as 5 mg in the morning and 5 mg in the evening.

1 tablet = 10 mg ½ tablet = 5 mg

CONTRA-INDICATIONS

Alatrol is contra-indicated in patients who have shown hypersensitivity or idiosyncrasy to it or to its parent compound, hydroxyzine

WARNING AND PRECAUTIONS

Activities Requiring Mental Alertness: In clinical trials the occurrence of somnolence has been reported in some patients taking Cetirizine: due caution should therefore be exercised when driving a car or operating potentially dangerous machinery.

DRUG INTERACTIONS

No clinically significant drug interactions have been found with theophylline, azithromycin, pseudoephedrine, ketoconazole or erythromycin and with other drugs

USE IN PREGNANCY AND LACTATION

There are no adequate and well-controlled studies in pregnant women using Alatrol. Therefore cetirizine should be used in pregnancy only if clearly needed.

Cetirizine has been reported to be excreted in human breast milk and thus, use of Alatrol in lactating mother is not recommended

SIDE EFFECTS

There have been occasional reports of mild and transient subjective side-effects such as, headache, dizziness, drowsiness, agitation, dry mouth and gastro-intestinal discomfort

Occasionally symptoms of hypersensitivity have been reported.

SYMPTOMS AND TREATMENT OF OVERDOSAGE

Drowsiness can be a symptom of overdose, occurring from administration of 50 mg of Alatro[®] as a single dose.

To date there is no specific antidote. In the case of massive overdose gastric lavage should be performed as soon as possible. Usual supportive measures should be provided and routine observations carried out regularly.

STORAGE CONDITION

Store at temperature not exceeding 30°C & Keep the product away from light.

Keep medicine out of reach of children.

Jauhkan daripada kanak-kanak

HOW SUPPLIED

Alatro[®] Tablet : Box containing 10 x 10 tablets in blister pack.

MANUFACTURED BY

SQUARE PHARMACEUTICALS LTD.

Dhaka Unit, Kaliakoir, Gazipur

Bangladesh.

DATE OR REVISION

JULY 2023